

YACHATDAC

Wonder — Guesting On-Country

Gallery leads the page, then title. Sticky enquiry panel follows the reader. No fixed dates, no pricing.

[Gallery — one large frame plus two, then a six-slot thumbnail strip: the wall, native foods, walking out, camp, fossil footprints, the escarpment.]

Guesting On-Country

A few days on Turraburra with the Traditional Custodians of this Country. You are welcome here, and you will be looked after.

Tags: Marra Wonga · Native foods · Cool burns · Camping · Central Western Queensland · Families & school groups

Register your interest

AT A GLANCE

WHERE Turraburra, 120km north of Barcaldine

GETTING HERE Fly to Barcaldine or Longreach and drive. Transfers can be arranged.

HOW LONG Half-day walks through to multi-day stays

SLEEPING Camping — swag or tent, shared meals, fire at night

BEST MONTHS May to September

WHO COMES Families, school groups, group bookings, international visitors

HIGHLIGHTS

MARRA WONGA

Place of many stories

160 metres of sandstone carrying fifteen thousand markings, read south to north.

NATIVE FOODS

Country you can eat from

Herbs, fruits, seeds and nuts, in scrub that looked empty on the drive in.

AFTER DARK

No town glow

The fire burns down and the sky comes all the way to the ground.

Getting here is part of it

From Barcaldine it is 120 kilometres north and the last stretch is dirt. Nobody arrives here by accident, and that is half the reason it is still what it is.

Aramac is the last town, 67 kilometres up the road, with a large white bull standing in the main street. In 1870 Harry Redford lifted a thousand head of cattle off Bowen Downs and walked them to South Australia. He sold a white bull along the way to buy supplies, which is how they caught him. The jury acquitted him anyway.

- Lake Dunn — Pajingo Bola, Big Fella Waterhole. The only wetland in Central West Queensland.
- Lake Dunn Sculpture Trail — a 200km loop out of Aramac, forty-plus sculptures built from scrap off local tips.
- Horsetailer's Gorge and the Healing Circle.
- Gray Rock — keep this one in mind.

There are figures carved at Gray Rock that were almost certainly cut by the same hand as the figures on our wall, and in the story, Wattanuri comes from Gray Rock. You will drive past one end of it to reach the other.

Turraburra

The property was called Gracevale for most of a century. It was bought back for our people in April 2019, and on 1 October 2020 we renamed it Turraburra, after the Terraburra clan recorded on this Country in an 1884 map. It runs to 8,870 hectares.

What a stay looks like

[Accordion — stages, not numbered days. Arriving open by default.]

Arriving

You get in, meet whoever is here, and set up camp. Swag or tent, and the fire going by dark.

The first night

There is no town glow out this way. When the fire burns down, the sky comes all the way to the ground. That is when the stories get told, by the people they belong to.

The Seven Sisters are up there, and they are carved into the wall you will walk in the morning. Same story, told twice, tens of thousands of years apart.

Walking out to the wall

Marra Wonga means place of many stories. We walk out through the woodland and come up under 160 metres of sandstone.

- Fifteen thousand markings — tracks, stars, grooves and drilled holes
- A snake eleven metres long, and human feet with six toes
- Ten clusters running south to north, telling one story in sequence
- Never scientifically dated

We tell you what we are able to tell.

Older than the wall

This Country was the floor of an inland sea. Creatures stood in the mud at the edge of it and the prints set. They are still here, along with petrified trees and what one visiting specialist thinks may be dinosaur eggs.

Out for food

The country that looked empty on the drive in is full of food. Herbs, fruits, seeds, nuts. First Peoples have eaten off this Country for tens of thousands of years and it is all still here. You learn what to look at, and then you keep seeing it.

Hands in the work

We do not run a set itinerary, because the work does not. Rain the night before and the morning goes to a cool burn while the ground is right. Seed on the grasses and we will be out collecting it. You join whatever is already happening, which is why no two groups get the same days and why nothing you see was put on for you.

One of our springs had been trampled flat by a hundred years of stock. We cleaned it out, planted grasses, and carted a thousand litres to it twice a day through drought. Eight days in it held a puddle. Next morning there was a koala standing at it.

If you want to put your hands in, you are welcome to. Most people end up wanting to.

WHAT'S INCLUDED

MEALS Shared meals cooked on site Native foods where the season allows.	GUIDING Hosted throughout By Suzanne, Graham and the Iningai Rangers, with access to Marra Wonga and the sites we are able to show.
CAMPING What we provide, what you bring Toilet and washing facilities.	TRANSFERS From Barcaldine or Longreach Available for an extra cost, arranged when you enquire.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION — every line above. This section is the most common reason an enquiry does not happen.]

Where you sleep

Camping. Swag or tent, meals shared, fire at night. Cabins and a lodge are planned for later, but this is what it is now, and most people who come out here want it this way.

[Image row — the camp, honestly.]

What it is like out here

- Red dirt, spinifex, and kangaroos on the track at dusk.
- Hot days. Winter nights get close to freezing.
- May to September is the comfortable stretch.
- Phone service drops out and does not come back until you head home.
- Distances between anything are long. Fuel up in Aramac.

Who you are with

Suzanne Thompson, Graham Ambridge and the Iningai Rangers host every group ourselves. This is the same Country we work every week, so you are with us the whole time rather than handed to a guide.

Ancient traditions walking together with contemporary visions. It is on our logo, and it is also just how the work gets done out here.

Stories from out here

[Dynamic — three most recent Resources posts tagged #lore, #country or #guesting. Editor can pin the first slot. Falls back to most recent overall. "See all" links to /resources/?tag=lore]

Take it with you

Download the brochure to share, print, or read offline.

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[Sticky panel — Register your interest, Download the brochure, four facts, and the line: no fixed dates and no pricing on this page, every stay is arranged with you.]

[COST — still undecided. Publish a from-price, or state plainly that it is quoted per group.]